

1894 – Hutchinson Glass Bottle

The Hutchinson bottle became Coca-Cola's first commercially bottled package, allowing the drink to move beyond soda fountains into homes and retail stores. Its internal wire-stopper seal preserved carbonation well, but the design was expensive, difficult to clean, and inconvenient for mass bottling, prompting a search for a simpler alternative.

1900 – Straight-Sided Crown-Top Bottle

Coca-Cola adopted a straight-sided glass bottle with the newly popular crown cap, making production faster, cheaper, and more reliable. However, many competitors copied the bottle's shape, making Coca-Cola difficult to distinguish on crowded shelves.

1915 – Contour Bottle Prototype

To combat imitation, Coca-Cola challenged glass manufacturers to create a bottle that could be recognized "even in the dark or if broken." Earl R. Dean's iconic contour design delivered a unique silhouette, instantly differentiating Coca-Cola from rival soft drinks.

1916 – Hobble-Skirt Contour Bottle

The production-ready contour bottle featured a slimmer waist for manufacturing stability while retaining its distinctive curves. Its memorable profile became a powerful brand asset, helping Coca-Cola establish one of the world's most recognizable packaging designs.

1923 – Revised Contour "Christmas Bottle"

The contour bottle received a refined patent with improved proportions for better production efficiency and consistency across bottling plants. Patented on December 25, 1923, it became affectionately known as the "Christmas Bottle" and remained the global standard for decades.

1955 – King-Size & Family-Size Contour Bottles

Responding to post-war consumer demand and larger family purchases, Coca-Cola introduced bigger contour bottles while preserving the iconic silhouette. The redesign allowed the brand to serve multiple consumption occasions without sacrificing instant recognition.

1960 – 12-oz Steel Soda Can

Coca-Cola entered the canned beverage market to meet rising demand for convenience, portability, and vending-machine compatibility. The lightweight steel can appealed to consumers on the move and expanded the brand beyond traditional glass packaging.

1978 – 2-Liter PET Plastic Bottle

The introduction of PET plastic bottles made Coca-Cola lighter, shatter-resistant, and ideal for supermarkets and family consumption. The 2-liter format significantly reduced transportation costs while matching changing household buying habits.

1993 – PET Contour Bottle

Advances in plastic molding enabled Coca-Cola to recreate its famous contour shape in PET, combining brand identity with the practicality of plastic. Consumers could now enjoy the iconic silhouette without sacrificing portability or durability.

2005 – Aluminum Contour Bottle

The sleek aluminum contour bottle was introduced primarily as a premium and limited-edition package for events, promotions, and international campaigns. Its modern metallic finish elevated Coca-Cola's image while celebrating the timeless contour design.

2009 – PlantBottle

Coca-Cola unveiled the PlantBottle, made partially from plant-based materials, as part of its sustainability strategy. The innovation reduced dependence on fossil-fuel plastics while maintaining the same appearance, strength, and recyclability as conventional PET bottles.

Present – Modern Recycled PET & Lightweight Contour Bottle

Today's Coca-Cola bottles combine the iconic contour shape with lightweight construction and increasing use of recycled PET to reduce environmental impact. The evolution reflects a shift from purely branding-focused packaging to balancing sustainability, manufacturing efficiency, and consumer convenience.